Research Report

Android App: StudyMate Student Planner and Progress Tracker

Introduction

This research report investigates existing Android applications that are similar to the proposed StudyMate app. StudyMate is planned as a student planner that helps users manage assignments, timetable entries, study sessions, reminders, and academic progress. The application will use Firebase for user accounts and stored data, and it will include a public quote API on the dashboard to provide a small motivational feature. The research focuses on three existing apps: MyStudyLife, Todoist, and School Planner. These apps were selected because they show different approaches to student planning and productivity.

The purpose of this report is to identify useful features, strengths, weaknesses, and implementation ideas that can guide the design of StudyMate. MyStudyLife is a student-specific academic planner; Todoist is a general task-management app with strong usability; and School Planner is a broad school organisation app with many academic tools.

Research on Existing Apps

App 1: MyStudyLife

MyStudyLife is a student planner app that focuses on classes, homework, exams, study planning, and grade tracking. Its feature page describes support for timetables, homework, exams, revision planning, grades, focus sessions, offline use, dark mode, and widgets. The Google Play listing also describes features such as reminders, a Pomodoro timer, grade tracking, and access across phone, computer, and iPad.

A major strength of MyStudyLife is that it is built specifically for students rather than for general productivity. The app uses academic categories such as classes, assignments, exams, and grades, which makes the structure relevant to its target users. It also supports complex timetables, including rotating schedules, and includes reminders and focus tools. This means the app not only stores deadlines; it also helps students act on them.

A weakness is that the feature set can feel large for a new user. A student who only wants to add one deadline may first need to understand several categories and screens. Public app ratings and reviews also suggest that some users may have issues with expectations or reliability. For StudyMate, the lesson is to keep the first version simpler: dashboard, assignments, timetable, study timer, and grade tracker.

In Android Studio, an app like MyStudyLife could be implemented using separate screens or fragments for Dashboard, Calendar, Tasks, Exams, Grades, and Settings. Firebase could store each user’s timetable, assignments, and grade records. Local notifications could remind the user about upcoming work, while a focus timer could be implemented locally using Android timer components.

App 2: Todoist

Todoist is a general to-do list and calendar app available on Android. The Google Play listing describes it as a planning centre for tasks, reminders, calendar events, projects, priorities, labels, and shared work. It also supports Android widgets, Wear OS, and quick task capture. Todoist is not designed only for students, but it is useful for research because many students use general productivity apps to manage academic work.

Todoist's main strength is fast task capture. Users can quickly enter tasks with due dates, labels, priorities, reminders, and project categories. The app also offers different views, including lists, boards, and calendar-style planning. Android widget support is another strength because users can see important tasks without opening the full app.

Its weakness for this project is that it does not understand academic concepts by default. A student has to manually create projects or labels for subjects, tests, assignments, and study sessions. StudyMate should borrow Todoist's simplicity for adding tasks but adapt it to student needs. For example, the Add Assignment screen should ask directly for subject, title, due date, priority, and reminder settings.

App 3: School Planner

School Planner is an Android app aimed at students in school or college. Its Google Play listing describes features such as homework, assignments, exams, reminders, timetable, calendar, themes, Google Drive backup, notifications, grade management, lecture recording, and teacher contact information. The listing shows a large user base, making it a useful competitor to study.

The app's strength is completeness. It covers many parts of student organisation in one mobile application and uses familiar Android interface patterns. Its calendar, timetable, grade, and notification features are especially relevant to StudyMate. It also includes useful extras such as teacher contacts and lecture recording.

A weakness is that a large feature set can make the app harder to maintain and test. Some features, such as lecture recording, require permissions and testing that may be too complex for a first development cycle. StudyMate should focus on the highest-value features with lower technical risk: assignments, study sessions, deadlines, timetable entries, grades, and reminders.

Comparison of All Three Apps

App	Main pur pose	Strengths	Weaknesses
MyStudyLife	Student planner	Academic categories, timetable, exams, grades, reminders, focus tools	Can feel complex; mixed public rating
Todoist	General task and calendar management	Fast task capture, priorities, labels, reminders, widgets, sync	Not student - specific by default
School Planner	School organisation app	Timetable, homework, grades, notifications, backup, Material - style design	Very broad feature set; some features add build complexity

The comparison shows that the best app for this project should be student-specific like MyStudyLife and School Planner, but simple and fast like Todoist. The strongest features to carry forward are assignment reminders, subject-based organisation, calendar or timetable views, grade tracking, progress feedback, and a clear dashboard. The final app should avoid unnecessary complexity in the first development cycle and should be designed so that unit testing can cover the main workflows.

Best Features to Use in StudyMate

- Dashboard showing today's classes, urgent tasks, and a motivational quote.
- Assignment manager with title, subject, due date, priority, status, and reminders.
- Timetable view for weekly classes and study sessions.
- Grade tracker that stores marks and calculates simple averages.
- Focus timer for study sessions.
- Firebase login and cloud storage so users can access their own data.
- Simple Material-style navigation with a bottom navigation bar.

Conclusion

The research shows that successful student planning apps combine fast task capture, clear reminders, timetable support, and progress tracking. MyStudyLife and School Planner demonstrate the value of student-specific features, while Todoist demonstrates the importance of speed and simplicity. StudyMate will combine these lessons into a focused Android app that is achievable within one development cycle. The planned use of Firebase and an external quote API also supports the technical requirements of the project while keeping the design practical for testing and future publication.

References

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